

Mapping With Melanin — City Data Seeding & Pin Designation System

Replit Implementation Instructions

Executive Summary

Mapping With Melanin has compiled comprehensive cultural guides covering **13 tour cities** and **4 satellite cities** with hundreds of cultural sites, diaspora-owned businesses, heritage landmarks, and community organizations — each with descriptions, addresses, and reference URLs.

The vision: Every pin in the app has content from day one. The app feels alive immediately. When a user opens the map in Charlotte or Atlanta or New Orleans, they see a rich, populated landscape of businesses and cultural sites with descriptions, photos, and context. Owners can claim their listings to tell their own story when they are ready — but the app never looks empty.

What this document covers:

1. A dual designation system that allows a single pin to be both a business AND a cultural landmark simultaneously
 2. A description/preview tab that gives every pin a "Learn More" experience from day one
 3. URL integration for external links and source tracking
 4. A phased seeding plan aligned with the national tour schedule
 5. Confirmation requirements before each phase ships
 6. The exact JSON format for bulk data import
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1. DUAL DESIGNATION SYSTEM

Concept

A single pin/listing can have **MULTIPLE designations simultaneously**. The real world does not fit into neat categories. Examples:

- A barbershop that has been open for 40 years is BOTH a `business` AND a `cultural_landmark`

- A church where civil rights meetings happened is BOTH a `community_resource` AND a `heritage_site`
- An HBCU campus bookstore is a `business` , an `hbcu` site, AND a `cultural_landmark`
- A mural painted on the side of a Black-owned restaurant makes that pin both `business` and `mural_public_art`

Schema Requirements

Add the following fields to the pin/listing schema:

TypeScript

```
// Pin designation system
pin_designations: string[]; // Array of all applicable designations
primary_designation: string; // Determines the pin icon/color on the map
// secondary_designations are derived: pin_designations minus primary_designation

// Allowed designation values:
type PinDesignation =
  | 'business'
  | 'cultural_landmark'
  | 'heritage_site'
  | 'community_resource'
  | 'historical_site'
  | 'hbcu'
  | 'mural_public_art';
```

Ownership vs. Stewardship

Designation	Can be "claimed" by owner?	Can be "stewarded"?	Notes
<code>business</code>	Yes	No	Standard claim flow
<code>cultural_landmark</code>	No	Yes (by community org)	Cannot be "owned"
<code>heritage_site</code>	No	Yes (by community org)	Cannot be "owned"
<code>community_resource</code>	Depends	Yes	Nonprofits can claim
<code>historical_site</code>	No	Yes	Cannot be "owned"

hbcu	No	Yes (by institution)	Institutional stewardship
mural_public_art	No	Yes (by artist or org)	Artist attribution

Pin Icon/Color System

Each designation type gets a distinct visual treatment on the map:

Designation	Icon	Color	Badge (when secondary)
business	Standard pin	Brand default	Small dot
cultural_landmark	Star / Monument	Gold	Gold star badge
heritage_site	Historical marker	Deep brown	Marker badge
hbcu	Graduation cap	Purple	Cap badge
mural_public_art	Palette / Brush	Teal	Palette badge
community_resource	Heart / Hands	Green	Heart badge
historical_site	Clock / Scroll	Sepia	Clock badge

Multi-designation pins display the PRIMARY icon with a small badge indicator in the corner for secondary designations. If a pin has 3+ designations, show the primary icon with a "+2" style indicator that expands on tap.

2. DESCRIPTION / PREVIEW TAB

Every pin gets a **"Learn More"** or **"About"** tab that displays rich content from day one. The content displayed depends on the listing's claim status.

For UNCLAIMED Listings (Seeded from Research Data)

These are businesses that have been imported from the cultural guide but whose owners have not yet registered in the app.

Display:

- **Description:** The research description from the cultural guide (this is the DEFAULT content that makes the app feel alive)

- **URLs:** Tappable links where users can learn more (official website, social media, etc.)
- **Cultural Community Tag:** e.g., "Ethiopian-owned", "Caribbean-owned", "Black-owned"
- **CTA Banner:** "This information was compiled by the MWM community. Is this your business? **Claim it to tell your own story.**"
- **Community Insights:** Community members can add insights, tips, and photos even before the owner claims it

Example card layout:

Plain Text

[Pin Icon] Got Jerk Island Grill	
★ Caribbean-owned (Jamaican)	
📍 1313 N 2nd St, Harrisburg, PA	
Authentic Jamaican cuisine prepared fresh daily. Popular dishes: Jerk Chicken, Curry Goat, Oxtails...	
🔗 Official Website	
🔗 Instagram	
ⓘ This info was compiled by the MWM community. Is this your business? [Claim it to tell your own story →]	
💬 Community Insights (3) "Best oxtail in the city" – @user123	

For CLAIMED Listings (Owner Has Registered)

Once an owner claims their listing, they take control of their story.

Display:

- **Owner's Story:** The owner's Layer 1 story video/text REPLACES the default research description as the primary content
- **Community Context:** The original research description moves to a collapsible "Community Context" section below the owner's story
- **Owner URLs:** Owner-provided URLs replace research URLs in the primary link section
- **Community Insights:** Community insights remain visible below the owner content

For Cultural Landmarks / Heritage Sites (Never "Claimed")

These pins represent places that belong to the community, not to any individual owner.

Display:

- **Description:** The research description is the PERMANENT base content (never replaced)
- **Community Stories:** Community members can add stories, photos, and context over time (Living Legacy content)
- **URLs:** Links to learn more are permanently displayed
- **CTA Prompt:** "Were you here? Share your story." — invites community contributions
- **Living Legacy Badge:** Visual indicator that this is a community-stewarded cultural site

3. URL INTEGRATION

Schema

Every listing supports structured URL arrays:

TypeScript

```
// External links for learning more
learn_more_urls: Array<{
  url: string;           // Full URL with protocol
  label: string;         // Display text (e.g., "Official Website", "National Regi
  source: 'research' | 'owner' | 'community';
}>;

// Social media links
social_urls: Array<{
  platform: 'instagram' | 'tiktok' | 'facebook' | 'twitter' | 'youtube' | 'webs
  url: string;
}>;
```

Source Tagging Rules

Source	When Used	Display Priority
research	URLs imported from the cultural guide data	Shown by default for unclaimed listings
owner	URLs provided by the business owner after claiming	Replaces research URLs in primary position

community	URLs added by community members	Shown in "Community Links" subsection
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Behavior

- All URLs open in the device's external browser (not in-app webview)
- Every URL tap is tracked via `/external-clicks` endpoint for analytics
- Track: `{listing_id, url, source, timestamp, user_id}`
- This data feeds into engagement metrics for business owners and investor reporting

4. PHASED SEEDING PLAN

Replit receives ALL city data at once as a reference document, but seeds the database in tour-phase order to align with the founder's travel schedule and ensure quality at each stage.

Phase Schedule

Phase	Timing	Cities	Priority Notes
A	Immediate (pre-tour)	Philadelphia	Already live — add missing cultural sites/landmarks only
B	Week of Aug 11	Charlotte, Raleigh/Durham	First tour stops. Charlotte is the first full city launch.
C	Week of Aug 18	Richmond, DC, Columbia	Next tour leg
D	Week of Aug 25	Atlanta	First full city launch with extra business attention (18-20 listings)
E	September	Montgomery, Birmingham, Mobile, Baton Rouge, New Orleans, Houston	Deep South leg
F	Ongoing	Allentown, Abington/Willow	Satellite cities — seed when testers in those

	Grove, Harrisburg, Chicopee	areas are active
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Per-City Seeding Checklist

For each city, complete the following:

1. **Import all businesses** with descriptions, coordinates, categories, and `cultural_community` tags
2. **Import all cultural sites/landmarks** with descriptions and URLs
3. **Import all heritage sites** with historical context descriptions
4. **Import community organizations** with contact info and descriptions
5. **Set** `listing_status: 'unclaimed'` for all business listings
6. **Set** `data_source: 'mwm_research'` to distinguish from owner-submitted data
7. **Geocode all addresses** — verify coordinates place pins at correct locations
8. **Verify all pins render correctly** on the map at all zoom levels (city, neighborhood, street)
9. **Test search** returns correct results for top 10 city-specific queries (e.g., "Ethiopian food Charlotte", "barbershop Atlanta", "civil rights Montgomery")
10. **Test designation filters** — user can filter map by designation type

Satellite City Seeding Notes

Satellite cities use the same data format but with additional fields:

TypeScript

```
city_type: 'satellite';  
parent_hub_city: string; // e.g., "Philadelphia" for Allentown
```

Satellite cities:

- Appear in search when users are within the regional radius of the parent hub
- Inherit Kinfolk city context from the parent hub
- Support community member submissions for new businesses and cultural sites (review queue)
- Require minimum: 5 businesses, 2 cultural sites, 1 community organization

5. CONFIRMATION REQUIREMENTS

Before moving to the next phase, Replit must confirm ALL of the following:

Map Rendering

- ☐ All pins have correct coordinates and render on the map
- ☐ Pins do not overlap excessively at city zoom level
- ☐ Pins resolve correctly at neighborhood and street zoom levels
- ☐ Pin icons match their `primary_designation` type
- ☐ Multi-designation pins show secondary badge indicators

Designation System

- ☐ Dual designations display correctly (primary icon + secondary badges)
- ☐ Tapping a multi-designation pin shows all designations in the detail view
- ☐ Designation filter on the map works (e.g., show only heritage sites)
- ☐ Designation badges render correctly on listing cards

Content & Descriptions

- ☐ The "Learn More" / "About" tab shows descriptions for EVERY pin (no empty states)
- ☐ Unclaimed business listings show the "Claim your business" CTA prompt
- ☐ Cultural landmarks/heritage sites show the "Share your story" prompt
- ☐ Descriptions render cleanly (no raw markdown, no broken formatting)
- ☐ Cultural community tags display correctly (e.g., "Ethiopian-owned")

URLs & Links

- ☐ All `learn_more_urls` are tappable and open in external browser
- ☐ URL taps are tracked via `/external-clicks` endpoint
- ☐ Social URLs display with correct platform icons
- ☐ No broken links (404s) in the seeded data

Search & Filtering

- ☐ Search returns correct results filtered by designation type

- ☐ Search returns correct results filtered by cultural community
- ☐ Search returns correct results filtered by category (restaurant, salon, etc.)
- ☐ The city filter works correctly (switching between cities shows only that city's pins)
- ☐ Satellite cities appear when searching within their parent hub's regional radius

Data Integrity

- ☐ All listings have `data_source: 'mwm_research'` tag
- ☐ All business listings have `listing_status: 'unclaimed'`
- ☐ No duplicate listings
- ☐ All required fields are populated (name, address, description, coordinates, designations)

6. DATA FORMAT FOR SEEDING

Full Feature City Format

JSON

```
{
  "city": "Charlotte",
  "state": "NC",
  "city_type": "full_feature",
  "parent_hub_city": null,
  "listings": [
    {
      "name": "Mert's Heart and Soul",
      "type": "business",
      "pin_designations": ["business", "cultural_landmark"],
      "primary_designation": "business",
      "category": "restaurant",
      "subcategory": "soul_food",
      "cultural_community": "Black-owned",
      "description": "A staple in Uptown Charlotte, Mert's offers award-winning",
      "address": "214 N College St, Charlotte, NC 28202",
      "coordinates": {"lat": 35.2295, "lng": -80.8428},
      "neighborhood": "Uptown",
      "learn_more_urls": [
        {"url": "https://www.mertscharlotte.com", "label": "Official Website",
      ],
      "social_urls": [
```

```

    {"platform": "instagram", "url": "https://instagram.com/mertscharlotte"},
  ],
  "listing_status": "unclaimed",
  "data_source": "mwm_research",
  "content_type": "standard",
  "feature_reason": "Long-standing community pillar with rich history and w
}
],
"cultural_sites": [
  {
    "name": "Harvey B. Gantt Center for African-American Arts + Culture",
    "pin_designations": ["cultural_landmark", "community_resource"],
    "primary_designation": "cultural_landmark",
    "category": "museum",
    "description": "Named after Charlotte's first Black mayor, this center is
    "address": "551 South Tryon Street, Charlotte, NC 28202",
    "coordinates": {"lat": 35.2186, "lng": -80.8488},
    "neighborhood": "Uptown",
    "learn_more_urls": [
      {"url": "https://www.ganttcenter.org", "label": "Official Website", "so
    ],
    "content_type": "living_legacy_eligible",
    "content_opportunity": "Visual content of contemporary and historical art
  }
],
"heritage_sites": [
  {
    "name": "Brooklyn Neighborhood (Second Ward ) Historical Marker",
    "pin_designations": ["heritage_site", "historical_site"],
    "primary_designation": "heritage_site",
    "category": "historic_neighborhood",
    "description": "The former Brooklyn neighborhood in the Second Ward was k
    "address": "Second Ward, Charlotte, NC 28202",
    "coordinates": {"lat": 35.2210, "lng": -80.8390},
    "neighborhood": "Second Ward",
    "learn_more_urls": [
      {"url": "https://www.charlottemuseum.org", "label": "Charlotte Museum o
    ],
    "content_type": "living_legacy_eligible",
    "content_opportunity": "Historical narrative on the erasure of Black neig
  }
],
"community_organizations": [
  {
    "name": "Charlotte Mecklenburg Black Chamber of Commerce",
    "pin_designations": ["community_resource"],
    "primary_designation": "community_resource",
    "category": "business_association",

```

```

    "description": "A non-profit organization serving Black-owned businesses",
    "address": "Charlotte, NC",
    "coordinates": {"lat": 35.2271, "lng": -80.8431},
    "learn_more_urls": [
      {"url": "https://www.cmbcc.org", "label": "Official Website", "source": "mwm_research"},
    ],
    "contact": {
      "phone": "704-212-2032",
      "email": "office@naricharlotte.com"
    },
    "listing_status": "unclaimed",
    "data_source": "mwm_research"
  }
]
}

```

Satellite City Format

JSON

```

{
  "city": "Allentown",
  "state": "PA",
  "city_type": "satellite",
  "parent_hub_city": "Philadelphia",
  "regional_radius_miles": 60,
  "minimum_requirements": {
    "businesses": 5,
    "cultural_sites": 2,
    "community_organizations": 1
  },
  "listings": [
    {
      "name": "This Life Forever Distillery",
      "type": "business",
      "pin_designations": ["business", "cultural_landmark"],
      "primary_designation": "business",
      "category": "distillery",
      "cultural_community": "Black-owned",
      "description": "Pennsylvania's first Black-owned distillery, producing vodkas, gins, and liqueurs.",
      "address": "Allentown, PA",
      "coordinates": {"lat": 40.6084, "lng": -75.4902},
      "listing_status": "unclaimed",
      "data_source": "mwm_research"
    }
  ],
  "cultural_sites": [],
}

```

```
"heritage_sites": [],  
"community_organizations": []  
}
```

7. CATEGORY TAXONOMY

Use these standardized categories for consistent filtering and search:

Business Categories

Plain Text

restaurant, cafe, bakery, bar_lounge, food_truck, market_grocery,
barbershop, hair_salon, beauty_supply, spa_wellness,
bookstore, art_gallery, clothing_boutique, jewelry,
distillery_brewery, fitness, professional_services, retail_other

Cultural Community Tags

Plain Text

Black-owned, Hispanic/Latino-owned, Ethiopian-owned, Caribbean-owned (Jamaican
Caribbean-owned (Haitian), Caribbean-owned (Trinidadian), Brazilian-owned,
West African-owned (Nigerian), West African-owned (Ghanaian),
West African-owned (Senegalese), West African-owned (Cameroonian),
Indigenous-owned, Asian-owned (Vietnamese), Asian-owned (Korean),
Asian-owned (Chinese), Asian-owned (Filipino), Asian-owned (Laotian),
Middle Eastern-owned (Lebanese), Middle Eastern-owned (Palestinian),
Middle Eastern-owned (Yemeni), Mixed Diaspora, Women-owned

Cultural Site Categories

Plain Text

museum, historic_church, hbcu, historic_neighborhood, monument_memorial,
mural_public_art, cultural_center, cemetery_burial_ground, civil_rights_landmar
performance_venue, market_historic

8. IMPORTANT IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

Do NOT create empty states

Every city that is seeded MUST have content for every pin. If a pin has no description, it should not be imported. The app must never show a pin that leads to a blank card.

Coordinate accuracy

All addresses must be geocoded to accurate lat/lng coordinates. Use a geocoding service (Google Maps API, Mapbox, or similar) to convert addresses. Do NOT estimate coordinates.

Cultural community is NOT optional

Every business listing MUST have a `cultural_community` tag. This is core to the app's identity and how users discover businesses that represent their community.

Description length

- Minimum: 50 characters
- Maximum: 500 characters for the card preview
- Full description (in Learn More tab): unlimited

Living Legacy eligibility

Any pin marked `content_type: 'living_legacy_eligible'` can receive community-contributed stories, photos, and videos over time. This is the foundation of the Living Legacy feature — the community builds the cultural narrative together.

Summary of Deliverables for Replit

1. **Schema updates:** Add `pin_designations`, `primary_designation`, `cultural_community`, `learn_more_urls`, `social_urls`, `listing_status`, `data_source`, `city_type`, `parent_hub_city` fields
2. **UI components:** "Learn More" tab, claim CTA, community insights section, designation badges, pin icon system
3. **Bulk import endpoint:** Accept the JSON format above for city data seeding
4. **Phased deployment:** Follow the phase schedule, confirm all checkpoints before advancing
5. **Analytics:** Track `/external-clicks` for all URL taps

The goal is simple: the app feels alive from the moment a user opens it in any seeded city. No empty maps. No blank cards. Every pin tells a story.